options in Tata Sons. Finally, among the suggestions approved was the listing of the company later after ‘carrying out detailed analysis’.

Ratan’s lack of support for the proposal to give stock options would have far-reaching implications for the group. If it had been approved, it would have opened the door to a flood of similar demands from other companies. His decision not to give any stock option of Tata Sons also prevented the dilution of the stake of the various Tata Trusts in Tata Sons. Importantly, in addition, it also obviated the possibility of the shares of Tata Sons falling into the hands of competitors or any organization hostile to the group if employees sold them, which would have raised existential issues for the group.

Besides this decision of inestimable value that he took, there were many areas in which TCS benefited because of Ratan’s policies. The decisions he took ‘made a substantial difference [to TCS], without any question’, recalls Ramadorai in an interview with me. In his book, *The TCS Story and Beyond*, he wrote that Ratan ‘always helped focus on the big picture and big dreams even if it meant taking risks’ and influenced the working of the company. The company specifically benefited from the adoption of many of the components of the restructuring programme. The reforms Ratan had introduced for the entire group and the positive energy they generated had considerable bearing on TCS. Of particular importance was the JRD QV Award and the TBEM process.

Different companies were adopting certain management tools to increase their efficiency and productivity. TCS used the Six Sigma methodology that provided organizational tools to increase business efficiency, and the Quality Management System. But the JRD QV Award was a programme that revolutionized the way the Tata companies viewed their own business, making them less sated with their success.

The award was a challenge to TCS to gain recognition for excellence. The assessors of the programme had to be presented with data. A ‘software excellence model’ had to be put in place to ‘qualify for the award’, recalled Ramadorai in his book. ‘To us the rigour and the digitization of the process and ultimately the measurement, got institutionalized to the nth degree,’ he elaborated.

The adoption of the TBEM process ‘increased predictability—because of the acceptance of the rigour, the performance got enhanced quarter on quarter’, comments Ramadorai. Elaborating, he says that the model also